

47.6 KEY LANGUAGE NON-DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSES

Non-defining relative clauses say more about a noun in the main clause. The main clause would still make sense without it.

MAIN CLAUSE NON-DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSE

We spoke to Linda, who had recently been mugged.

Comma separates the clauses.



When they are in the middle of a sentence, they are separated from the main clause by two commas.

MAIN CLAUSE NON-DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSE RETURN TO MAIN CLAUSE

Her necklace, which she'd just bought, was stolen.

Comma comes before and after relative clause.



47.7 FURTHER EXAMPLES NON-DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSES

The suspect, whom we had been following, was arrested.

"Whom" is only used in very formal situations.



All the burglars were arrested, which was a great relief.

The relative pronoun can refer to the entire previous clause



47.8 REWRITE THE SENTENCES, ADDING COMMAS WHERE NECESSARY

The burglars who were arrested last night will be in court today.

The burglars, who were arrested last night, will be in court today.

❶ The violent criminals were not sent to jail which surprised the victim.

❷ Detective Smith who arrested the fraudster works in a special department.

❸ Vivian Jones who had worked for the bank for 10 years was arrested yesterday.

